

Chef-Style Tiramisu Gateau

With Tia Maria & Grand Marnier

 *Luscious layers. Boozy brilliance. A dessert that whispers Italian and screams, "I'm extra."*

 **Serves:**

8–10 slices (or just you with a fork and no regrets)

 **Time Required:**

1 hour hands-on · 4–6 hours chill time (overnight if you're a saint)

Part 1: Sponge Cake Base (Genoise Style)

You'll need:

- 4 eggs
- 100g castor sugar
- 100g plain flour, sifted
- 25g cornflour
- Pinch of salt
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

Method:

1. Preheat oven to **180°C**. Line a 9-inch round cake tin with baking paper.
 2. Place eggs and sugar in a bowl over simmering water. Whisk until warm and frothy – think warm bubble bath but edible.
 3. Take off the heat. Beat with a mixer until thick and ribbony.
 4. Gently fold in sifted flours, salt, and vanilla. *Slow and sexy wins the race.*
 5. Pour into tin. Bake for **20–25 minutes**, or until golden and springy.
 6. Let it cool. Slice into **2 or 3 layers**, depending on your ambition and caffeine levels.
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Part 2: Liqueur Coffee Soak

Mix together:

- 180ml strong espresso
- 60ml Tia Maria
- 60ml Grand Marnier
- 15ml sugar syrup (*optional – if you're feeling sweet*)

Important tip:

Brush it onto your sponge layers – *don't* soak it like a sponge in a mop bucket. You want bold flavour, not a coffee swamp.

Part 3: Mascarpone Cream Filling

What you'll need:

- 500g mascarpone cheese
- 300ml thickened cream
- 4 egg yolks
- 100g castor sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- Zest of 1 orange

How to whip it:

1. Gently whisk yolks and sugar over a double boiler until it thickens – like a smooth custard.
 2. Cool it down completely (like your ex never did).
 3. Fold into mascarpone and vanilla.
 4. Whip the cream to soft peaks, then fold in along with the orange zest.
 5. Chill it for **10 minutes** – just enough time to clean the spoon you *definitely* licked.
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Part 4: Assembly

You'll need:

- A springform pan (that fancy one with the clicky sides) or a cake ring
- The sliced sponge cake
- The liqueur coffee soak
- That dreamy mascarpone filling

Bonus tip:

If you want smooth, professional sides, line your pan with **clear plastic strips** — yep, just plain old clear plastic (like the kind used in cake shops). Don't have it? Use baking paper or go commando. Rustic is in.

Now build this beauty:

Sponge → brush with soak → slather with cream → repeat.
End with a glorious final layer of cream on top.

Cover it and chill in the fridge for at least **4–6 hours** (overnight gives peak deliciousness). Hide it behind the celery. No one will look there.

Part 5: Topping & Presentation

When you're ready to serve, glam it up with:

- Whipped cream (piped rosettes if you're feeling extra)
- Fresh strawberries (they slice through the richness like a gossip at brunch)
- White chocolate curls (optional, but oh-so-fancy)

Use a **hot, dry knife** to slice like a pro. No dragging. No tears.

Chef's Notes

- Tia Maria gives that deep espresso elegance.
- Grand Marnier lifts it with sweet citrus flair.
- Orange zest and strawberries balance it all out so you don't feel like you've eaten a brick of cream.
- It's a *mousse-style* gâteau — airy, boozy, blissful.

Cooked once. Nailed it. Always repeated.

My Notes:

Cooked once. Nailed it. Always repeated.